

Benjamin S. Manning

CONTACT	bmanning (at) mit.edu ◇ benjaminmanning.com	
EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology	
	Ph.D. Management Science, Information Technology	2022 - Present
	Committee: <i>John Horton (Chair), Christopher Avery, Colin Camerer</i>	
	S.M. Management Research	2024
	Harvard University	
	M.P.P. Economic & Social Policy	2021
	Washington University in St. Louis	
	B.A. Mathematics (College Honors)	2017
GRANTS (\$483,325)	Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Award (\$193,325)	2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)	2025
	MIT GenAI Impact Consortium & OpenAI (\$180,000; w/ John J. Horton)	2025
	Schmidt Sciences Grant Proposal Award (\$10,000)	2025
	Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)	2024
AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS	EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award	2026
	WISE Best Paper Award	2025
	Harvard Distinction in Student Teaching Award	2025
	Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp	2025
	Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,500)	2022
	Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,000)	2019
WORKING PAPERS	General Social Agents	
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton)	
	Revise & Resubmit at <i>Econometrica</i>	
	• WISE 2025 Best Paper Award	
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i>	
	• Media: Marginal Revolution	
	Automated Social Science: Language Models as Scientist and Subjects	
	(Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , & John J. Horton)	
	Reject & Resubmit at <i>The Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>	
	• EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award (one of six)	
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i>	
	• Media: Marginal Revolution	
	Large Language Models as Simulated Economic Agents: What Can We Learn from Homo Silicus?	
	(John J. Horton ¹ , Apostolos Filippas ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹)	
	Revise & Resubmit at <i>The Review of Economics and Statistics</i>	
	• Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '24)</i>	
	How AI Prompts Can Teach Us About the Structure of Human Behavior	
	(Matthew O. Jackson ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Yutong Xie ¹ , Walter Yuan, & Qiaozhu Mei)	

¹Indicates first author or co-first author

Self-Supervised Preference Learning for Multimodal Foundation Models
(Akshata Tiwari¹, Jillian Ross, **Benjamin S. Manning**, & Andrew Lo)
Under Review at NeurIPS

SELECTED
WORK IN
PROGRESS

AI Agents as Flexible Commitment Devices: Evidence from the Field
(**Benjamin S. Manning**¹ & Alex Moehring¹)

Taste-as-Program: Scalable Preference Elicitation with AI
(Gili Rusak¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**¹, & John J. Horton)

Mass In Silico Replication of Social Science Experiments
(Jacob Snyder¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**¹, John J. Horton¹, & Abhishek Nagaraj¹)

What Causes Price Bubbles? Theory and Evidence from Simulations and the Lab
(Cady Ngo¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**¹, Christopher Avery¹, & Colin Camerer¹)

PEER-
REVIEWED
PUBLICATIONS

Prompt Adaptation as a Dynamic Complement in Generative AI Systems
(Eaman Jahani¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**, Joe Zhang, Hong-Yi TuYe, Mohammed Alsobay, Christos Nicolaides, Siddharth Suri, & David Holtz)
Information Systems Research, 2026

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), MIT Ideas Made to Matter, Columbia Business School Insights

National Megastudy Shows that Email Nudges to Elementary School Teachers Boost Student Math Achievement, Particularly When Personalized
(Angela Duckworth¹, Katherine Milkman, ... **Benjamin S. Manning**, ..., & 26 others)
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2025

Effect Size Magnification: No Variable is as Important as the One You're Thinking About—While You're Thinking About It
(Linnea Gandhi¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**, & Angela Duckworth)
Current Directions in Psychological Science, 2024

- Top 10 most downloaded Association for Psychological Science (APS) journal articles in 2024
- Media: [Under the Cortex](#)

REFEREED
CONFERENCE
PROCEEDINGS

Strategic Tradeoffs Between Humans and AI in Multi-Agent Bargaining
(Crystal Qian¹, Kehang Zhu¹, John J. Horton, **Benjamin S. Manning**, Vivian Tsai, James Wexler, & Nithum Thain)
ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI), 2026

BOOK
CHAPTERS

The Coasean Singularity? Demand, Supply, and Market Design with AI Agents
(Peyman Shahidi¹, Gili Rusak¹, **Benjamin S. Manning**¹, Andrey Fradkin¹, & John J. Horton¹)
Forthcoming in *The Economics of Transformative AI*

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy

TEACHING

BUSN 38802: Managerial Decision Making; **TA for Richard Thaler**, University of Chicago—Booth London Campus, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.7/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.6/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2023 (Rating: 4.3/5.0)

GUEST
LECTURES

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2025

QSTBA 830: Business Experimentation and Causal Methods; **Andrey Fradkin**—Boston University, Spring 2025

AFFILIATIONS

MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, Heterodox Academy

REFEREEING

Economics: *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Experimental Economics*, *Southern Economic Journal*

General Interest: *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences Nexus*

Management: *Management Science*, *Manufacturing and Service Operations Management (MSOM)*, *International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*

Computer Science: *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, *ACM Conference on Collective Intelligence*

Sociology: *Sociological Science*

Program Committees: *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2026)*, *The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI) (2026)*, *Workshop on Agent Behavior at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) (2026)*, *Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE) (2023)*

Grants: *J-PAL Project AI Evidence*, *Schmidt Sciences Scaling AI Safety for a Multi-Agent World*

INVITED
SEMINARS

2026 (Includes scheduled talks): LSE (Centre for Philosophy of Natural and Social Science); University of Connecticut (Operations & Information Management); Chapman University (Business and Economics)

2025: Dartmouth College (Economics); Instacart Economics Team

2024: Instacart Economics Team

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

2026 (Includes scheduled talks): AI in Social Science Conference (UChicago); AI and Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); NBER AI and Economic Measurement; Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data Conference; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Digital Economy Workshop (Athens); AEA Annual Meeting.

2025: Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE); North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA); KOF ETH Zurich and IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online; Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; NBER/CEME Decentralization and AI; Khipu Latin American Meeting in AI; AEA Annual Meeting.

2024: National Association for Business Economics (NABE); Econometric Society Conference on Economics and AI and ML; ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT; International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics; Statistical Conference in E-Commerce Research (SCECR); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Microsoft Research AI, Cognition, and the Economy Workshop; Measuring Development: AI, the Next Generation at the World Bank.

2023: MIT Computer Science and AI Lab (CSAIL) (FutureTech)

EMPLOYMENT	University of Pennsylvania Research Assistant for Angela Duckworth	2021 - 2022
	University of Chicago Research Assistant for Jon Rogowski	2020 - 2022
	Dartmouth College Research Assistant for Sydney Finkelstein	2018 - 2019
	Phetpittayakom School High School Math Teacher in Thailand	2017 - 2018
	Optiver US LLC Execution Trading Intern	2016